intersex
NIGERIA
CENTER FOR HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT & YOUTH EMPOWERMENT

A STRATEGIC MANUAL ON INTERSEX RIGHTS ADVOCACY IN NIGERIA

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We extend our deepest gratitude to the dedicated team at Intersex Nigeria whose tireless efforts and unwavering dedication ensured that this manual became a reality. Your passion for advocacy and your commitment to amplifying the voices of intersex persons have been instrumental in shaping this invaluable resource.

We are also immensely grateful to our esteemed stakeholders, including the National Human Rights Commission Lagos State, the National Identity Management Commission, as well as traditional and religious leaders, whose invaluable insights and support have enriched the development of this manual. Your collaboration and engagement have been instrumental in ensuring that the rights and dignity of intersex persons are upheld and respected.

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As we embark on this journey toward equality and justice, we are deeply grateful for the support and collaboration of each and every one of you. Together, we can create a world where every individual is valued, respected, and empowered to live authentically.

FOREWORD

Welcome to the Intersex Rights Advocacy Manual—a groundbreaking resource designed to challenge norms, dismantle barriers, and champion the rights and visibility of intersex persons in Nigeria.

In a world where the rigid binary classification of gender often overlooks the unique experiences of intersex persons, this manual serves as a beacon of hope and empowerment. It acknowledges the prevailing lack of awareness and understanding surrounding intersex variations, recognizing the vulnerability of intersex persons to human rights violations, from medical interventions without consent to societal discrimination and stigma.

The urgency for advocacy and awareness-building around intersex rights cannot be overstated. With the widely accepted gender binary as the norm Intersex persons are often excluded from legal protections and societal recognition, this manual offers a comprehensive resource to challenge existing barriers, providing guidance and strategies for advocacy to empower organisations, government agencies, policy makers, intersex persons, parents, and individuals to effect meaningful change and foster inclusive environments.

At its core, this manual is a testament to our unwavering commitment to promoting human rights and dignity for all. It embraces the term "intersex" as an inclusive umbrella, rejecting stigmatising and pathologizing language to affirm the inherent dignity and worth of every intersex person.

As we embark on this journey toward equality and justice, we invite you to join us in advocating for the rights and well-being of intersex persons in all their diversity and intersections. Together, we can challenge outdated and primitive norms, dismantle discriminatory practices, and build a society that embraces diversity and respects the inherent dignity of all its members.

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to all who have supported and contributed to the creation of this manual. Your unwavering commitment to intersex rights is a beacon of hope for a future where every person regardless of their SOGIESC is valued, respected, and empowered to live and develop authentically.

Thank you for your dedication and support.

ABOUT INTERSEX NIGERIA

Intersex Nigeria, formally established in 2019 and officially registered in Nigeria in 2021, stands as a symbol of support and empowerment for intersex persons in Nigeria. Located in Nigeria, West Africa, and impactfully spread to other African countries our organisation is unique in that it is led by intersex persons themselves.

Our overarching goal is to champion the sexual and reproductive health, self-determination, bodily autonomy, and fundamental human rights of intersex individuals across Nigeria. We achieve this through a multifaceted approach that includes community building, advocacy, evidence-based research, empowerment initiatives, and the dissemination of educational resources on intersex-related issues to various stakeholders, partners, and the wider community. This involves supporting and empowering intersex individuals and their families through online forums, social activities, and face-to-face meetings; providing information, education, and advice on intersex issues via the internet and Information Communication and Education materials; leading and contributing to policy-making processes that protect and provide comprehensive healthcare services for intersex people; increasing support, awareness, and recognition of intersex rights with commitment from different stakeholders; engaging and partnering with other organisations that share common goals; and raising, applying, and channelling resources to support the standard of living of intersex persons while ensuring their safety and sustained development.

At the core of our vision lies the desire to see a society where intersex persons, from birth, have rights to bodily integrity and autonomy and are free from stigma and discrimination. We envision a future where stigma and discrimination against intersex individuals are eradicated, replaced instead by a culture of inclusivity, visibility and understanding.

Our mission is clear: to create an enabling society that promotes the visibility, inclusion, bodily autonomy, sexual and reproductive health including mental wellbeing and human rights of intersex persons in Nigeria, through community organising, research, advocacy, empowerment and public engagements using a feminist lens. We as Intersex Nigeria design all our projects with this mission in mind.

Ultimately, our aim is to ensure that intersex individuals in Nigeria, from the moment of birth and throughout their lives, are granted the fundamental rights to bodily integrity and autonomy, liberated from the shackles of stigma and discrimination. Through our tireless efforts, we strive to pave the way towards a future where every intersex person can thrive, unimpeded by societal prejudices.

INTRODUCTION

Why an Intersex Rights Advocacy Manual?

The classification of humanity into two distinct sex—male and female—permeates public understanding and organisation of social structures, and this leads to the exclusion and erasure of intersex persons. However, this binary perspective fails to account for individuals who completely fall into these categories. This drives a prevailing lack of knowledge on intersex variations, people and the rights that should accrue to them within Nigerian society. This raises a significant concern as intersex persons are left vulnerable and exposed to severe human rights violations.

The wide understanding of male and female bodies along with the corresponding medical, social and intellectual norms, has given rise to commonplace unnecessary medical and surgical interventions many of which are carried out on intersex persons many times without the informed consent or proper consultation of the individuals themselves. Intersex persons are denied agency over their bodies due to the complex interplay between gender norms, medical practices, and societal attitudes. Such a state of affairs is contrary to individual autonomy and dignity principles that form the foundation of fundamental human rights. Intersex persons in Nigeria face significant socioeconomic, medical, and political challenges, which have over time resulted in various forms of dehumanization such as infanticide, intersex genital mutilation, discrimination, stigmatization, police exploitation and extortion, chronic mental health challenges and disenfranchisement of their human rights. In Nigeria, the Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria 1999 provides a starting point for the promotion and protection of their rights. Human rights are constitutionally guaranteed under Chapter IV of the 1999 Constitution as amended. These rights are referred to as inalienable rights and include the right to life (Section 33), right to dignity (Section 34), right to personal liberty (Section 35), right to fair hearing (section 36), right to privacy and family life (section 37), right to freedom of thought conscience and religion (section 38), right to freedom of expression and press (section 39), right to peaceful assembly and association (section 40), right to freedom of movement (section 41), and right to freedom from discrimination. In recent years, there has been a greater recognition and awareness of the specific human rights abuses against intersex persons.

These include violations of their rights to be free from torture and ill-treatment; rights to health and physical integrity, rights to equality and non-discrimination; rights protecting them from forced and coercive medical interventions, infanticide, restrictions on the exercise of legal capacity and access to remedies and justice; rights to education, sport, employment and services. Intersex Nigeria hopes to gradually challenge the lack of policies, laws and other social barriers that hinder the promotion and protection of intersex visibility, acceptance, and inclusion by creating an advocacy manual that will guide and inform the organisation's advocacy strategies.

A key step toward a holistic approach to addressing human rights violations against intersex persons is the development of this strategic advocacy manual with consultation from relevant stakeholders. This manual is created to empower human rights advocacy groups to advocate for the rights and raise awareness about intersex issues at all levels in Nigeria.

What is 'intersex'?

'Intersex' is an umbrella term to describe people who are born with natural sex characteristics (including genitals, gonads and chromosome patterns) that do not fit typical binary notions of male or female bodies.

Intersex persons have been referred to as 'hermaphrodites', persons with 'disorders of sexual development' (DSD) or disorder in sex Differentiation. However, both terms are stigmatizing and pathologizing. Describing something as a 'disorder' infers that it is something that has to be corrected.

How was this manual created?

Intersex Nigeria (Center for Healthcare Development and Youth Empowerment) is an intersex-led non-governmental organisation in Nigeria in collaboration with key stakeholders drawn from civil society organisations, rightholders, local activists and traditional influencers within Nigeria's Human rights advocacy space. A three-day strategic advocacy meeting. The consultations aimed to identify the key human rights challenges and obstacles intersex persons in Nigeria face, including when they advocate for their own rights, and to identify good practice examples, success stories and useful methods for intersex rights advocacy. Omolara Oriye of Liberation Alliance Africa facilitated the consultations.

In this manual, 'advocacy' refers to taking action to create or foster change in policy, legal or societal environments for intersex persons in Nigeria in accordance with local, regional and international human rights standards. It involves identifying issues and key experiences of Intersex persons in Nigeria, analysing them and identifying key methods to advocate for the promotion and protection of the rights if intersex persons in Nigeria. It means speaking up for an intersectional approach to human rights advocacy for intersex persons in Nigeria.

The following are key terms in this manual:

- **Advocacy action:**
  The individual targeted action (the letter, the report, the protest, the meeting) within a planned series of actions, directed at resolving an identified issue.

- **Advocacy objective:**
  The short or medium-term result which is necessary to achieve in order to reach the long-term goal. The objective is what the advocacy actions aim to achieve.

- **Advocacy goal:**
  The long-term result which you want to achieve and to which the advocacy objectives lead.

- **Advocacy strategy:**
  A set of tools and methods employed in the pursuit of set advocacy goals, sequenced in a consistent and coherent manner over time.

How to use this manual

The manual should be read from start to finish, but it is also designed so you can dip into it as required.

How is the manual structured?

Following the introduction and a brief overview of some basic definitions, the advocacy manual is structured in three sections.

Section 1

Conceptualising Advocacy:
Advocacy
Advocacy and power
Strategic Analysis for effective Advocacy

Section 2

Legal and Social realities of intersex persons in Nigeria
How to Advocate for Human Rights of Intersex Persons In Nigeria
Who are the Stakeholders?
Identifying Stakeholders
Engaging Stakeholders
Advocacy Strategies for Intersex Rights in Nigeria
Sustaining Advocacy

Section 3

Leveraging the United Nations Human Rights mechanisms to advocate for Intersex Rights.

Section 1

WHAT IS ADVOCACY?



Advocacy is the act of supporting or promoting a cause, idea, or policy to bring about specific changes or improvements. It involves efforts to influence decision-makers and raise awareness about a particular issue to achieve desired outcomes.

Specifically, advocacy is a set of well thought out, organized actions aimed at influencing public policies, social attitudes, or political processes. Advocacy can include the following:

- Enabling and empowering people to speak for themselves.
- Providing support to a policy and persuading those with power to act in support of the policy at local, national, and international levels.
- Gaining and exercising power to influence a political action.
- Organizing efforts by citizens to influence the formulation and implementation of public policies and programs by persuading and pressuring state authorities international financial institutions, and other powerful actors.

How then is advocacy for intersex rights? To adequately advocate for the rights of intersex persons, it is important to understand the key challenges faced by this community within a certain context.

Brief overview of key human rights challenges of Intersex persons in Nigeria

- Legal recognition.
- Lack of protection from violence.
- Lack of access to comprehensive healthcare services and information.
- Inadequate inclusion in intersex education to Educational systems.
- Unnecessary and medical and traditional harmful practices.
- Lack of respect for the right to dignity and non discrimination.
- Biases and myths that continue to sustain inequality and non inclusion.

To formulate a comprehensive definition of intersex advocacy, such a definition should encompass the key challenges identified above others as identified by advocates.

For the purpose of this manual, **"Intersex Advocacy in Nigeria is the process of engaging key stakeholders to promote healthcare, recognition, protection, access to healthcare, anti-discrimination laws, support, and related rights for intersex individuals in Nigeria**.

This involves the identification of key stakeholders across all levels, amplifying diverse voices to promote human rights and enhance and achieve social and systemic change.

Who can Advocate for intersex persons in Nigeria?

Rights holders - intersex themselves may advocate on behalf of their causes. Rights holders refer to individuals or social groups who hold specific entitlements concerning particular duty-bearers. In the context of this advocacy manual, intersex persons are the right holders. Intersex individuals, given their unique lived experiences, possess firsthand knowledge, a personal stake, and a passionate commitment to advocating for intersex rights. The key advantage here is legitimacy: rights holders can advocate while making reasonable compromises in their interests. However, the drawback is that they may lack the necessary resources and access to key stakeholders.

Advocacy with rights holders, in this case, rights holders collaborate with human rights activists to advocate for their rights. This approach combines the strengths of the previous category with the knowledge, expertise, resources, and access that community-based organizations (CBOs) can offer. Additionally, numerical strength is a significant asset. However, the challenge here lies in the potential over-politicization of the issue or the risk of the CSOs (Civil Society Organizations) involved in hijacking the advocacy.

Advocacy for rights holders, where human rights activists take full charge of the advocacy process. This approach is recommended in situations where the civic space is heavily restricted by state actors. This category often excels in terms of access to decision-makers, but the challenge is the potential lack of participation and representation of the rights holders' group, which can make it difficult to ensure that the wishes and opinions of the rights holders are accurately reflected.

Advocacy and Power

Power is a fundamental aspect of everything in the world, and advocacy is no exception. Therefore, advocates are encouraged to assess their socio-political and geographical context to understand the power dynamics at play. Advocacy can be seen as the exercise of power by affected people in the face of the government's power. Effective advocacy requires using different approaches to tap into various sources of power. To achieve social change, advocates must be aware of the political and social power structures at play. A power map is a useful visual tool for figuring out who you need to influence, how to influence them, and who can do the influencing to reach a specific goal. This increases the probability that a government will be responsive to its citizens. Some of these approaches contribute to the accumulation and consolidation of social power, while others contribute to the strengthening of technical capacities.
Advocates for intersex rights must have a clear awareness of their location. Spatial and power location is important not only to activists themselves but also in the assessment

of power and influence possessed by external bodies and individuals. At times, due to the intricate interplay of power, advocates may need to be flexible and adapt to various situations to gain access to strategic individuals and spaces. Advocates need to evaluate the power they hold so that they can effectively use their leverage and negotiate for the changes they seek.

Think about this definition of advocacy in relation to power.

> *"Advocacy is the process of redistributing power from the government to the citizens."*

Note: You can interchange the word government here to identify your potential advocacy target.

Power Mapping

Once you have identified your primary and secondary advocacy targets, the next step is to assess their positionality and their level of support or lack of support for your cause. Power mapping is a valuable tool for visualizing the perceived influence held by different stakeholders and whether they are likely to endorse the desired changes.

When creating a power map, advocates must be precise. It is not sufficient to simply mention "Government Agencies." Instead, it's necessary to specify which exact government agencies and the particular individuals within those agencies are the focal points. It's important to understand that when developing a power map, there is no middle ground. Stakeholders are either in support of the cause or not; there is no neutral territory.

A power map is typically presented as a quadrant, meaning it consists of four distinct sections:

The upper left corner represents parties with significant power or influence who do not support the cause. (a)

The upper right corner represents parties with substantial power or influence who strongly support the cause. (b)

The lower left corner represents parties with limited power or influence who do not support the cause.(c)

The lower right corner represents parties with relatively less power and influence, yet they still support the cause. (d)

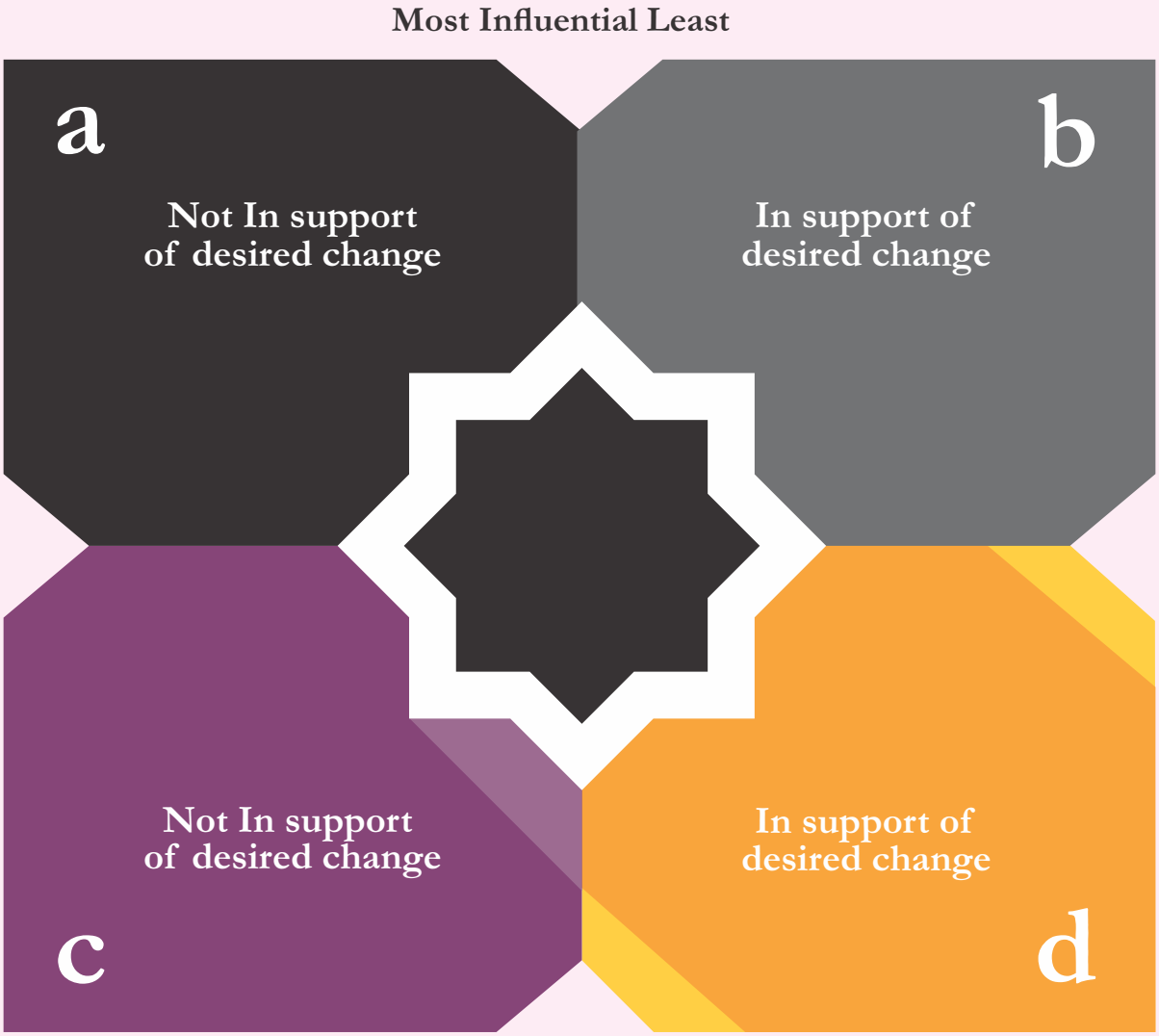


Fig.1: Power Map

Analysing your Advocacy problem

Advocacy strategy for intersex rights must be based on a thorough analysis of the problem. It must consider the context of the human rights crisis, the policy, political and cultural environment. The problem analysis is best developed in coordination with partners, especially affected people, and organisations led by affected people as well organisations, networks and movements. Analysis of the policy environment is a critical step in understanding the causes and effects of various issues and formulating effective advocacy strategies. Relevant and reliable information gathering is central to problem analysis for advocacy. Key information for problem analysis may be gathered

from the affected groups (intersex persons), local partners, external experts, government sources, and other NGOs. This also includes gathering policy related information.

Key Considerations

Many advocacy strategies have difficulty in achieving their goals for a variety of reasons.

The problems they seek to address are not clearly defined or understood.
The "problem" is not perceived as a priority problem by a large number of people—especially by excluded groups whom the advocacy is intended to benefit;
The problem identified is not narrowed down sufficiently to a specific issue with a workable strategy.

Sometimes these mistakes occur because advocacy strategies respond more to donor trends than real needs and opportunities for change. In other cases, the way a problem is defined does not match the way it is experienced by those people. So, those affected cannot relate to the proposed solution.

Tools For Problem Analysis

The Problem Tree: Problem Trees help to analyse an advocacy problem by mapping out the anatomy of cause and effect around an issue. A problem tree is a representation of an identified problem, suspected causes, and effects. The objectiveof drafting a problem tree is to get a shared understanding and a clear picture of the problem and underlying factors.

Example of a problem tree



Fig.2: Example of Problem Tree

Problem Trees help to analyse an advocacy problem by mapping out the anatomy of cause and effect around an issue. A problem tree is a representation of an identified problem, suspected causes, and effects. The objective of drafting a problem tree is to get a shared understanding and a clear picture of the problem and underlying factors. The diagram above indicates that one problem might have numerous causes, and numerous effects on societies. Note: A root cause may sometimes have its own root cause and it is our work as advocates to dig as deep as we can to avoid a cosmetic approach to a fundamental problem.

Advantages of a problem tree

- There is more understanding of the problem and its sometimes interconnected and even contradictory causes. This is often the first step in finding win-win solutions.
- It can help establish whether further information, evidence or resources are needed to make a strong case, or build a convincing solution.
- Present issues – rather than apparent, future or past issues – are dealt with and identified.
  The process of analysis often helps build a shared sense of understanding, purpose and action.

Note: When using a problem tree to analyse advocacy issues, the policy-related problem or issue is written in the centre of the flip chart and becomes the trunk of the tree. The causes and consequences of the focal problem become the roots. The question of 'why' an issue is a problem needs to be repeatedly asked to find the root causes.

Key considerations

Which causes and consequences are improving, which are getting worse and which are staying the same?
What is the gendered nature of the problems identified?
What are the most serious consequences?
Which are of most concern?
What criteria are important to us in thinking about a way forward?
Which causes are easiest/most difficult to address?
What possible solutions or options might there be?
Where could a policy change help address a cause or consequence, or create a solution?

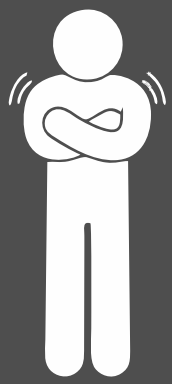
Problem Analysis Tool 2
The problem analysis framework

By breaking down the issue into sub issues, and asking the question 'why' under three headings: consequences, causes and solutions, certain useful and core information may be revealed. This framework can easily be replicated on a flip chart for collective thinking or in a notebook for individual concentration. This framework can generate so many suggestions under each heading that it is advised to prioritise the top three consequences, find three major causes for each, and limit to three solutions per sub issue. These can then be considered for their advocacy opportunities, chances and obstacles.

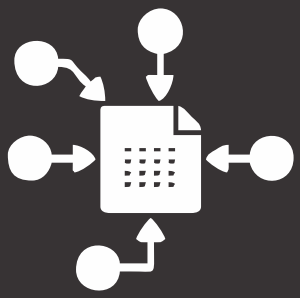
Example of a problem analysis framework

Sub issue	Consequences	Causes	Solution
Blackmailing of Intersex persons based on gender identity and sexual characteristics by law enforcement authorities	Intersex people afraid to report crimes committed against them to the police Cause	Ignorance within police force No mechanism for Institutional accountability Lack of information available to intersex people on their rights	Comprehensive Anti discrimination Legislation Documentation by activists to monitor and gather data on the problem Require production of print and web material on human rights of Intersex people and self help networks, etc









Context analysis

Why do you need a context analysis?
Effective advocacy is based on a good understanding of the local context and the issue you are working with. The history and the social, political, cultural, economic and environmental conditions of a country or a region shape. This will help to determine which causes or consequences to focus advocacy efforts on. During the context analysis, critical insights are developed. They can then be reframed into potential advocacy issues. Potential, because further prioritization is required to define the key issue or issues that will become the focus of the advocacy campaign.

It is important to consider:

- The likelihood of change taking place
- The positions, ideas and values of the organizations and individuals with an interest in change
- The effectiveness and potential impact of different activities or tactics.

If you understand the context better, you can create a more effective advocacy strategy and have a better chance of making a difference.

When should you conduct a context analysis?

Do a context analysis, when analyzing your issue and planning your advocacy. Be aware of changes to the context — political, cultural, economic context before and during your advocacy. This helps you to know if you should change your tactics, it encourages dynamism.

How to conduct a context analysis

It is helpful to break down the process of undertaking a context analysis into manageable chunks using a PESTLE analysis. This tool promotes a systematic understanding of the wider environment. It can also help to identify new issues and opportunities on the horizon; to create scenarios; and to develop a coherent vision. PESTLE stands for: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal and Environmental factors or trends.

A PESTLE analysis studies the key external factors (Political, Economic, Sociological, Technological, Legal and Environmental) that influence your advocacy process

Context	Suggested questions	Implications for your Advocacy
Political	• What kind of political system are you working in? • What are the political priorities for the current government? • How open is the policy-making system? • How responsive is the policy-making system to civil society? • How free is the media? And how responsive is the media to civil Society? • When are the next elections?	
Economic	•What is the current economic situation in your country or local area? • What are the current spending priorities of the government?	
Economic	What social or cultural factors affect your issue? • Are there particular social groups that are affected either by the problem or the solution you might propose?	

Social/Cultural	• What are the social, cultural and religious myths about intersex persons? • How far-reaching and powerful are the religious, social and cultural leaders/influencers?	
Technical	• Are there any technologies that may help or hinder your advocacy strategy?	
Legal	• What are the legal frameworks that apply to your issue? • Are there international conventions or national constitutional provisions which are relevant? • Is there relevant legislation?	
Environmental	• Are there key environmental/ecological factors that need to be considered that are linked to your issue? • Are there key international organizations and players that affect the issue? • Are there relevant conventions, guidelines or policy processes at the international level?	

Section 2

LEGAL AND SOCIAL REALITIES OF INTERSEX PERSONS IN NIGERIA



Intersex activism in Nigeria is a growing area of advocacy and much of the lived experiences of intersex people are excluded from mainstream documentation on human rights violation, violence, stigma and discrimination. Until recently, there has been sparse data on the legal and social realities of intersex persons in Nigeria and this has impaired advocacy efforts. In Nigeria, the legal and social recognition of intersex persons remains a complex issue, largely overshadowed by cultural norms and legal frameworks that adhere strictly to definitions of binary sex identities and bodies. Intersex individuals often face significant challenges due to the lack of awareness and acceptance within society. Nigerian law does not currently offer explicit protections for intersex persons, leaving them vulnerable to discrimination in various aspects of life, including healthcare, education, and employment.

Social stigma and misinformation about intersex variations contribute to a hostile environment for those affected. Families may subject intersex children to invasive unnecessary medical procedures without informed consent, aiming to align their physical appearance with societal gender norms and avoidance of possible shame and stigma from family and society. Such actions, often carried out at a young age, can lead to long-term physical and psychological harm. The combination of misconceptions, harmful social and religious attitudes, stigma and taboos and the lack of non-pathologizing information perpetuate human rights violations against intersex persons in Nigeria. These attitudes prevent them from speaking out, accessing social services such as healthcare, and participating within their community. Intersex persons and their families are also unable to access helpful information, peer support, and legal services leading to further invisibility.

The Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria 1999 provides a starting point for the promotion and protection of intersex persons in Nigeria. Human rights are constitutionally guaranteed under Chapter IV of the 1999 Constitution. These include the right to life (Section 33), right to dignity (Section 34), right to personal liberty (Section 35), right to fair hearing (section 36), right to privacy and family life (section 37), right to freedom of thought conscience and religion (section 38), right to freedom of expression and press (section 39), right to peaceful assembly and association (section 40), right to freedom of movement (section 41), and right to freedom from discrimination.

Access to fundamental human rights protections remains a challenge for intersex persons in Nigeria. For example, Access to justice for intersex persons in Nigeria remains difficult due to the lack of legal recognition and specific protections for their rights. Without explicit legal provisions, intersex individuals are forced to face discrimination, violence, and other human rights abuses on their own. The legal

system inadequately addresses their unique needs and concerns, making it difficult, to near impossible to access justice when their rights are violated, both in public spaces and within their own families and communities.

Access to healthcare is another significant challenge for intersex persons in Nigeria. Medical professionals frequently lack the training and sensitivity to address the specific needs of intersex individuals. The emphasis on surgical intervention as a corrective measure, rather than a focus on informed consent and bodily autonomy, further exacerbates the issue. This disregards the human rights of intersex persons and places them at risk of health complications and identity erasure.

Research shows that access to employment in Nigeria is challenging for intersex persons in Nigeria due to widespread discrimination and societal stigma surrounding intersex variations. There are no workplace policies and legal protections addressing the rights of intersex individuals as is common in informal economies. As a result, intersex individuals face barriers when seeking employment and experience discrimination during the hiring process or while on the job.

Discrimination in the workplace against intersex persons in Nigeria takes various forms, including direct rejection during job applications due to physical intersex variations, unequal treatment in terms of job assignments, promotions, or benefits, and even harassment from coworkers or employers. Employers largely hold misconceptions or biases about intersex individuals, leading to exclusion from job opportunities based on their intersex status rather than their qualifications and abilities.

Social and cultural discrimination, exclusion, and violence against intersex persons in Nigeria are deeply rooted in various aspects of the society. Mythical, cultural, and religious beliefs label intersex persons as unnatural and an abomination. Intersex individuals are born with sex characteristics that do not fit typical definitions of male or female sex characteristics, and they often face significant challenges in Nigeria due to prevailing attitudes and beliefs. A lack of awareness, ignorance, lack of information about intersex variations solidify these socio-cultural beliefs that contribute to the exclusion and fetishisation of intersex persons, giving rise to sexual violence and other forms of sexual harrasment against them.

Efforts to advocate for the rights and recognition of intersex persons in Nigeria face numerous obstacles, from societal prejudice to legislative inertia. However, there is a growing awareness among human rights organizations about the need to include intersex issues in their advocacy work. Encouragingly, some NGOs are beginning to

focus on raising awareness about intersex advocacy, aiming to foster a more inclusive and informed society. This involves challenging harmful stereotypes and advocating for legal reforms that recognize and protect the rights of intersex individuals.

Legal reforms are critically needed to provide explicit protections against discrimination and to ensure that medical practices affecting intersex individuals adhere to principles of consent and bodily autonomy. Cultivating a societal environment that values diversity and respects the rights of all individuals, regardless of their sex characteristics, is essential for the well-being and acceptance of intersex persons in Nigeria.

Why Advocacy for Intersex Rights in Nigeria must be Intersectional



Activism and advocacy for intersex rights often do not account for the many different contexts oppression is expressed in – for example, race, ethnicity, gender, disability, age, and class – in which discrimination, violence and other human rights violations play out.

Yet, it remains difficult to account for the experience of multiple types of oppression especially because one is unable to unpick which thread they suffer from most – these oppressions are experienced intersectionaly. To determine that intersex people's rights are isolated and exclusive is to overlook the existence of the multiple identities and circumstances that shape and determine how people experience their lives. An intersectional approach has great scope to address discrimination and violations perpetrated by both State and non-state actors. As described by the scholar Kimberle Crenshaw, intersectionality describes the ways that different forms of injustice intersect in ways that compound experiences of discrimination and violence. For example, in a 1991 paper, she describes how "the experiences of women of colour are frequently the product of intersecting patterns of racism and sexism" which "tend not to be represented within the discourses of either feminism or antiracism" so that "women of colour are marginalized within both". In this way, one can assert that intersex discrimination may not be experienced separately from other discriminatory factors and relationship to oppression.

Intersectionality does not imply that one person is more marginalised than another. Instead, it signifies that their intersecting identities shape each person's experiences.

At times, individuals may find it challenging to pinpoint which specific identity contributes to their human rights situations and experiences. Within the context of the experiences of intersex Nigerians, sexism, ableism, structural violence, poverty, lack of access to legal recognition and legal protections, the imposition of gender norms, and homophobia as well as other factors form part of the experience of oppression. Drawing a parallel between intersex genital mutilation and female genital mutilation, one sees that both practices share a common driving factor Control — the desire to compel individuals to conform to social norms and expectations that perpetuate patriarchy.

For example, intersex individuals whose bodies deviate from societal expectations, leading to discrimination and bullying. Similarly, structural violence — is a permanent state of violence, which is embedded in the social, political and economic structures that make up a society. Due to the absence of a concrete person and its camouflaged nature, it is also known as indirect violence. Structural violence is often accepted as the norm but it deeply impacts the lived experiences of intersex persons in Nigeria.

Intersectional analysis posits that we should not understand the combining of identities as additively increasing one's load, but instead as producing substantively distinct experiences. In other words, the intention is not to demonstrate that one group is more victimised or privileged than another, but to reveal meaningful distinctions and similarities in order to overcome discrimination and put the conditions in place for all people to fully enjoy their human rights. Intersectionality is a tool for analysis, advocacy and policy development that addresses multiple discriminations and helps comprehension of how different circles of identities impact people's access to rights and opportunities. This approach is critical in human rights and development work, and it suggests new and different approaches for the efforts of human rights advocates.

In our analysis and advocacy, it is therefore important to stay aware of tactics used by the hegemonies to further marginalize the citizens. These are Exploitation, penetration and segmentation. Exploitation is based on unjust economic and social relations. It happens within complex structures and at the end of long and ramified legislation chains and cycles. It represents the main part of an archetypical violence structure and means nothing more than just a situation of 'unequal exchange' in which the 'top dogs' or the elite, benefit from the exchange, leaving the underdog to survey and often die. The effect of this inequality is far-reaching, often permanent, and deeply rooted in the minds of so many that it is tolerated and normalised. The elites implant their ideologies within the proletariat, thereby reinforcing and maintaining control over them. This is also achieved through segmentation, wherethe privileged

group controls the perspectives and experiences of the underprivileged. The mechanisms of segmentation include "Marginalization" and "Fragmentation."

There are many examples where an intersectional approach has been used to advance the human rights of people, where intersecting identities inevitably led to higher vulnerability. These offer visions of how the approach could be used. For example, in 2014 a story of a large group of people with diverse sexual orientation and gender identity (mostly youth and even children), who were living in a storm drain in New Kingston, Jamaica, was widely distributed across news (internet and print) media. Their situation was made visible and gained the attention of the Jamaican government and the general public because of a series of local and international investigative journalistic pieces that highlighted their plight.

Intersectionality is a vast subject that a narrowed approach cannot do justice to and, if we do not look at the intersections, we are at risk of painting an incomplete picture, which fails to see or acknowledge the very real ways that multiple marginalised identities play out in intersex lives. Addressing human rights violations against intersex people through the intersectional perspective of any relevant subject will help to move towards meaningful and comprehensive advances. It will demonstrate the multiple ways that intersectionality can be used, and how it has the potential to reveal interlocking relationships of oppression and privilege, exposing how experiences of Intersex people vary due to the intersections of gender, ethnicity, class, religion, birthplace, politics, etc.

With an intersectional lens, activists, human rights defenders, policymakers, and stakeholders can also uncover how political, economic and social structures such as patriarchy, capitalism and neo-liberalism generate and perpetuate social inequality in all spaces of societies. It can show how the State's institutions produce and replicate systems of oppression based on gender, sexuality, class, race, gender, religion, and ability, amongst others, all of which play in simultaneous ways and affect particularly the most marginalised individuals and groups.

Advocacy Targets

Advocacy targets are individuals or groups who possess the authority and influence required to address requests and facilitate the achievement of desired social changes. In the context of advocacy, targets are the decision-makers whom you want to influence. Identifying the decision-makers is tricky, and there is no formula for finding it. Before this discussion, we must distinguish between **a decision-taker** and **a decision-maker.** A decision-taker is the person who ultimately signs off on the

policy or the decision. The higher the rank of the decision-taker, the more remote they are from making the decision. Being a person with several responsibilities, they would rather assign the formulation of the decision to one of their subordinates. The decision-maker is the person who prepares the decision for the official's approval and signature. Your advocacy efforts should target the decision-maker with less advocacy effort directed at the decision-taker. Again, finding the real decision-maker is tricky as they are not necessarily officially responsible.

Advocacy targets are classified as Primary and Secondary targets. Advocacy "targets" is an umbrella that requires further analysis. The "Primary Target" is the most influential person in making the decision. Additionally, there are **Official Targets:** Often, the official target, or the person we should officially address, is not who makes the decision. Showing due respect to the official target is important to shield your campaign from the pitfall of ignoring the due process. **Support Targets** also play a role in the decision-making process but are not the most influential. They are the other committee members who could show some support (or resistance) to the primary target. Reach out to those targets to reduce any resistance they might show if they hear about your requests for the first time. **Access Targets** are those who can give us access to the primary target. The person could be the driver, the administrative staff, the spouse, or even distant family members of the primary target.



What distinguishes primary targets from secondary targets?

The classification of targets into primary or secondary is based on their influence and power, not only as a collective group or as individuals but also in their capacity to effect the desired change. For instance, a Ministry of Environmental Protection would hold significant influence in advocating for the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions. Still, it would not be considered a primary target in advocating for the rights of the girl child or an intersex person. While identifying advocacy targets, it is important to ask "Can this individual or group influence and bring about change?"

Identifying the stakeholders

Before you begin to identify stakeholders for Intersex advocacy, remember that engaging in advocacy means engaging in politics. Engaging in politics requires a robust analysis of power to understand who influences decision-making, why each stakeholder does that, and how they do it. In other words, effective advocacy *requires a solid understanding of the power balance to allow for effective engagement in the politics behind policy-making.*

Advocacy Stakeholders

Potential stakeholders are those who are interested in or can influence the advocacy process. Stakeholder analysis helps to determine which institutions and individuals have a stake in an issue, as well as their interests, support or opposition, influence and importance. The first step is to identify the people, institutions and organisations with a stake in the protection and promotion of intersex rights in Nigeria. The next critical step is to analyse the stakeholders you have identified. This is done in a plethora of ways and there is no one point in time when we exclusively carry out this exercise. Nevertheless, we need to go through this exercise after setting our campaign objective(s) to help us anticipate the response of different people and groups to the objectives we set.

Before we go into the details of analyzing the stakeholders, here are a few key points to remember.

- **Engaging in advocacy means engaging in politics.**

Engaging in politics requires a robust analysis of power to understand who influences decision-making, why each stakeholder does that, and how they do it. In other words, effective advocacy requires a solid understanding of the power balance to allow for effective engagement in the politics behind policy-making.

- **Analyzing stakeholders brings these linkages to reality.**

Your engagement in the political process and changing the power dynamics are crucial in and by themselves.

- **It is imperative to remember that there are no permanent friends or enemies in politics.**

Your staunch supporters in one issue could be your worst enemy in another. It would be best if you always work based on this principle. You cannot take people for granted unless you approach them on each issue every time and secure their explicit support for your position on the issue. You may be surprised at finding unlikely allies and shocked at disappointing friends.

- **Always remember that you are dealing with individuals and not groups.**

One of the very common mistakes is that we assume that institutions have one position. The reality is that within any institution, you can find contradicting opinions. The official position of an institution may be against you. But if you dig deep enough, you may find supporters within this institution whose voices are not loud enough. It is important to seek such individuals and check if they are willing to cooperate with you.

Stakeholder Analysis

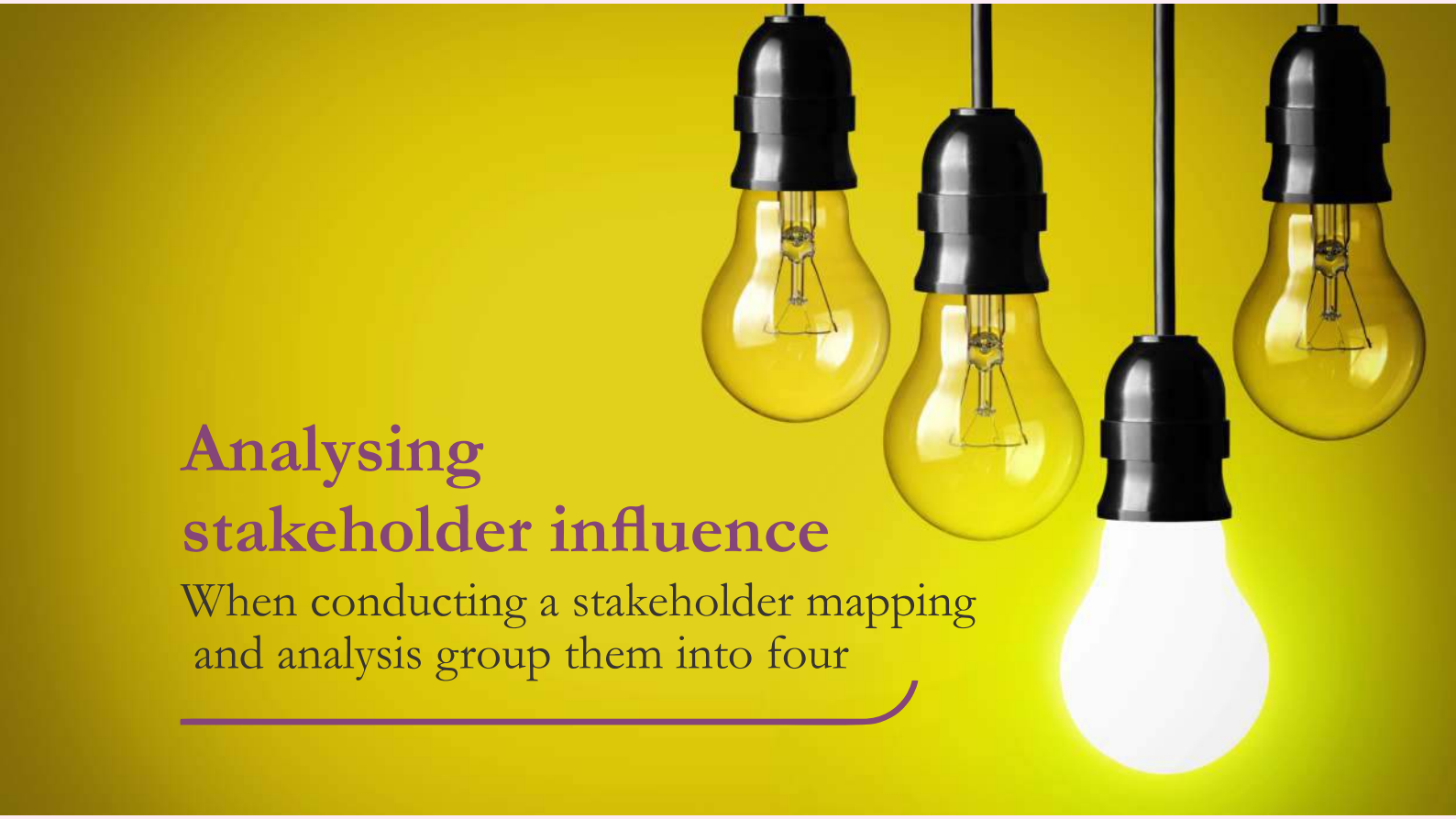
Simply put, stakeholder analysis is a key step in planning and implementing your policy advocacy campaign. It helps you to understand the perspectives, interests, and motivations of the different actors involved in or affected by your issue. Stakeholder mapping is a way for the implementation team to learn the perspectives of stakeholders, their affiliation and area they represent, and what interests and/or perspectives they bring to the advocacy for intersex persons.

Identify:

It is important to identify the key stakeholders from the large array of groups and individuals that could potentially affect or be affected by the proposed change. Oftentimes, when stakeholders are spoken of, often forgotten are parties that are negatively impacted by the process. Negative stakeholders are parties who will or perceive themselves to be negatively affected by the change that is advocated for. In programming your advocacy campaign, it is expedient that you take into cognizance these people, this is part of risk assessment. Ignoring this population might lead to you being caught unaware when they carry out activities to hinder your campaign.

- **Assess stakeholder's** interests, influence and the potential impact of advocacy on these interests by asking critical questions that inform you of a stakeholder's interest, power and willingness to support your advocacy goals.

Mapping stakeholder groups supports the process for the development of an engagement plan. This helps with the judicious use of your resources by not over communicating or over investing with groups that do not require the same level of investment as your high interest and high influence group, and by making sure to engage your higher interest and influence groups in greater depth.



Analysing stakeholder influence

When conducting a stakeholder mapping and analysis group them into four

- **Low Interest & Low Influence**

  For stakeholders with low interest and low influence, one-way communication of essential information will likely be sufficient in most instances.

- **Low Interest & High Influence**

  This group is more influential than the low interest-low influence grouping. Although they still have a low interest in regular communication from your organization, it's important to monitor this group regularly, keep them informed of critical information, and anticipate any interests or needs they may have.

- **High Interest & Low Influence**

  This group is more interested than the low-low grouping. Although they may not be as influential as other stakeholders, you may wish to have regular, robust communication and consider two-way communication with this highly interested stakeholder group.

- **High Interest & High Influence (these are your KEY stakeholders)**

  This group is both interested and influential and will require more resources to engage with effectively. This is your priority grouping of stakeholders who will require regular, robust, two-way communication tactics to keep this group satisfied.

Categories of stakeholders

Your advocacy should be a deliberate process, involving intentional actions. Therefore, it is important to carefully and strategically categorize your identified stakeholders as part of the analysis process. It should be clear who you are trying to influence and why you are trying to influence them. It is useful to break this large group down into smaller categories of like-minded people in order to recognize where participants fit into your advocacy vision. Here are a few categories you may explore.

- **Right Holders**

  People whose lives will be improved by the policy change. Rights holders are the most important stakeholder group, but they can often be passive stakeholders (whereas 'allies' are actively involved).

- **Internal stakeholders**

  People within your own organization who are involved in the advocacy project in some way e.g. staff, volunteers, management board etc. Some may be only lukewarm about the advocacy project or be resource competitors.

- **Allies**

  People who are 'on your side' – either because they will directly benefit from the policy changes, or because they want to bring about these changes for reasons of justice.

- **Adversaries or opponents**

  People who are opposed to the policy change. They may be actively opposed to the policy change. Or they may be ignorant or uniformed – these could be potential allies, given greater understanding. Adversaries could be the targets of your advocacy campaign.

- **Targets**

  People whom you wish to influence. Primary targets are those with the ability to affect your objective directly. Secondary targets are those who can influence primary targets.

Identifying stakeholders for intersex Advocacy in Nigeria
Drawing from the stakeholder conversations hosted by intersex Nigeria these key Stakeholders have been identified.

- Intersex persons
- National Human Rights Commission
- National populations Commission
- Federal Ministry of Health
- Nigerian Bar Association
- Federal Ministry of Women's Affairs
- Federal Ministry of Youth and Social Development
- Universal Basic Education Board
- Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria
- Nigerian Medical Association
- Nurse and Midwives Council of Nigeria
- National Association of Nigerian Nurses and Midwives
- National Primary Health Board
- Traditional Birth Attendants
- Child Protection Network
- Parents of intersex persons
- Traditional and Social Media
- Faith-based Organisations
- Mainstream Human Rights NGOs, CBOs and Civil society
- Inclusive Human Rights NGOs, CBOs and Civil society
- National Identification Management Commission
- Traditional and religious leaders
- Anti-rights and anti-gender organisations/movements

Engaging Stakeholders

At its most basic level, stakeholder engagement is the process of identifying, developing and maintaining relationships with specific individuals or entities that are impacted by or have influence over the issues or goals that are important to your advocacy goal. An understanding of the groups that have a stake in your advocacy including their priorities, needs, and capabilities will aid in the development of shared advocacy goals and opportunities to collectively work toward achieving them

Key Strategies for Dealing with Opponents and Allies

The main strategies for dealing with opponents are likely to be:

- Persuading them that your position is right, or weakening their opposition to your position

- Reducing their influence (often by affecting their credibility by successfully countering their arguments) for example anti rights groups.

It is important to seek some common ground on some issues and agree to disagree on others but remain aware of when to stop.

The main things you need to find out about your opponents are

- Why do they oppose you?
- How actively will they oppose you?
- Will they be reactive (just counteracting your moves) or proactive?
- What will they do to challenge you?
- What battleground are they likely to choose?
- How much power do they have (money, influence, numbers)?
- What are their strategies and tactics?
- What are their policies and beliefs?
- Are there areas where you might agree?
- Who influences them?
- Who is influenced by them?

Strategies for dealing with allies

The main strategies for dealing with allies are likely to be:

- Persuading the ally that your position is right
- Persuading the ally that the issue is important enough to warrant action
- Building alliances

The main things you need to find out about your allies are:

- How well do they support your advocacy issue?
- Do they have any misgivings about your advocacy campaign? If so, what are they?
- What do they hope to gain from the advocacy?
- How well resourced are they in terms of the campaign?
- What are they willing to do to support the campaign?
- How involved and informed do they expect to be?
- Do they have issues with any other prospective allies?

Strategies for Engaging Stakeholders

Advocacy: Engage with identified policymakers, legislators, and government officials to advocate for the development and implementation of comprehensive anti-discrimination laws that protect intersex persons in various aspects of their lives, including employment, housing, healthcare, education, public services, and public accommodations.

Coalition Building: Facilitate the formation of strategic alliances and intersectional coalitions with organizations, human rights groups, legal professionals, and other stakeholders to create a unified voice for comprehensive anti-discrimination laws.

Research and Analysis: Conduct research and analysis to gather evidence, data, and case studies that highlight the necessity and impact of comprehensive anti-discrimination laws. This research will support advocacy efforts and provide a foundation for evidence-based policymaking.

Education and Training: Develop educational materials and conduct training programs for legal professionals, policymakers, and community leaders to enhance their understanding of intersex issues, the importance of comprehensive anti-discrimination laws, and their practical implementation.

Sustaining your Advocacy

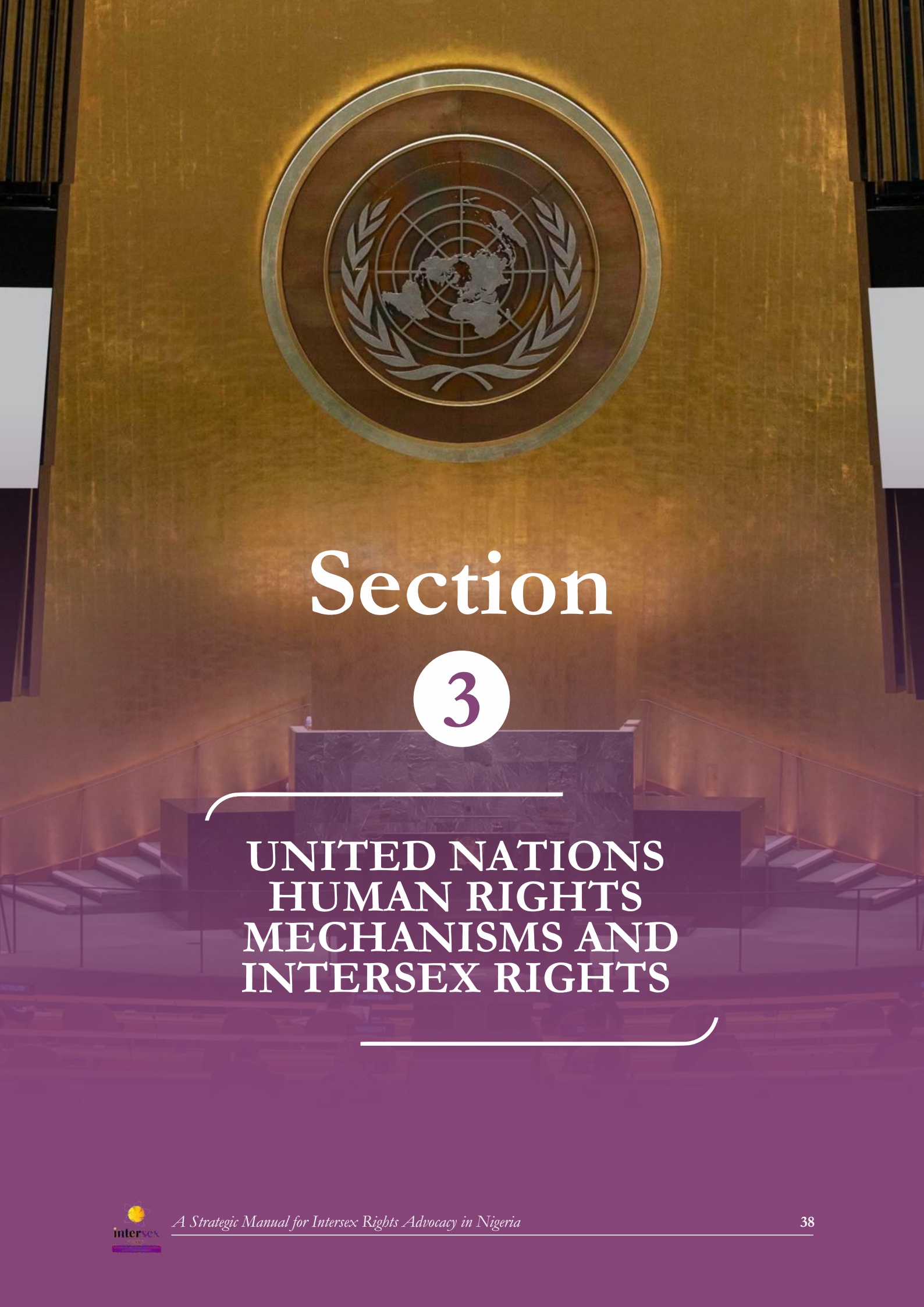
- Define the Desired Change: Clearly articulate what change is desired as a result of the project.
- Set a Time Frame: Establish a timeframe for achieving the desired change.
- Identify Measurable Milestones:
- Break down the project into measurable milestones to track progress.
- Continue to analyse advocacy context (Physical, Social, cultural) and organisation/group's position. Taking the context into account helps advocates navigate issues and factors that can positively or negatively impact the desired goal.

- Institutionalize the Goal: Institutionalizing a change involves dismantling oppressive structures and establishing progressive ones.
  This could include repealing laws, creating supportive policies, or implementing standard operating practices within agencies.
  For example, in intersex advocacy, it might involve developing a training guide with Intersex Nigeria for agency staff, ensuring that the training continues even after the project.

- Adopt an Intersectional Approach: Institutionalization can also be achieved by adopting an intersectional approach, where partners take up the advocacy cause.

- Maintain Consistent Stakeholder Interaction: Regularly engage with stakeholders to keep the project's goals at the forefront of their priorities.
  This is crucial as stakeholders may be involved in various other issues.

In essence, these strategies aim to embed the advocacy goals within the community, create lasting structures, and ensure ongoing commitment and support.



Section 3

UNITED NATIONS HUMAN RIGHTS MECHANISMS AND INTERSEX RIGHTS

Intersex persons, like all persons, are entitled to the protection, respect, and fulfilment of all of their human rights, as enshrined in the Universal Declaration of Human rights and core international human rights treaties including the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, the Convention against Torture and other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment, the Convention on the Rights of the Child, the Convention on the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination against Women, the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, among others.

For example, current medical practices towards intersex people contravene a wide range of human rights. Non-consensual and uninformed unnecessary interventions contravene the right to bodily integrity in article 17 of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD); the right to liberty and security of person in article 3 of the UDHR, article 9 of the ICCPR and article 14 of the UNCRPD; and also the nonderogable prohibition on torture or cruel, inhuman or degrading treatment or punishment as outlined in article 5 of the UDHR, article 7 of the ICCPR, article 37(a) of the UNCRC, article 15 of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD), and articles 2 and 16(1) of the The United Nations Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment (UNCAT).

In Nigeria, it is established that Intersex persons face barriers in accessing appropriate healthcare, Intersex people can face discrimination in education and employment This is protected against in articles 2 and 7 of the UDHR, articles 2(1) and 26 of the ICCPR, article 2 of the ICESCR and article 2 of the UNCRC. Such discrimination can be direct, due to obvious physical differences and bullying and mistreatment, or indirect, due to environments which are not accommodating for individuals who may need to take extended periods of time away for medical treatments or may require reasonable adjustments.

UN Mechanisms

International human rights law provides the foundation for the work of UN Human Rights and the mechanisms it supports. This legal framework was born with the adoption of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR), the first document in history to set out fundamental human rights. Together with two international covenants, it now forms the International Bill of Human Rights. Since the UDHR was adopted in 1948, it has inspired a series of legally binding international human rights

treaties, declarations and other instruments, all underpinning and guiding UN Human Rights' mechanisms.

Here are a few mechanisms intersex advocates can explore.

Human Rights Council

The Human Rights Council is an intergovernmental body within the United Nations system made up of 47 States responsible for the promotion and protection of all human rights around the globe.

Universal Periodic Review

The Universal Periodic Review is a unique process which involves a review of the human rights records of all UN Member States.

The Special Procedures of the Human Rights Council are independent human rights experts who report and advise on country situations or thematic issues in all parts of the world. They are not paid and are elected for three-year mandates.

Human Rights Council Mandated Investigations

UN-mandated commissions of inquiry, fact-finding missions and investigations respond to situations of serious violations of international humanitarian law and international human rights law. They promote accountability for these violations, and counter impunity.

Collaborating with international institutions for advocacy at regional and international mechanisms.

It is important to note that collaborating with international institutions to engender intersex rights requires strategic relationship building and lobbying. Remember that every institution has a mandate, which dictates the scope and reach of their work, the interventions possible, and their official position on matters arising. Identify your advocacy problem, analyze them, and determine what the purpose of the specific stakeholder is for your goal. It is equally important to set out your advocacy asks in the order of priority. Focus your message, request, or question; have credible and accurate evidence on your issue; and be prepared with documentation in order to achieve this target.

During the visit with the institution's representative it is important to find out from them:

- How the mission will be reported.
- How, where, and when that information will be delivered.
- Will there be any recommendations?

To maintain relations with the individuals in the office you have dealt with, it is important to do the following.

- Share information: try to help institutions when they are in need of information and demonstrate how their work can help your work.
  It is important to be informed of the organization's mandate – be aware of what they can and what they cannot do.
- Invest in professional relationships and personal contacts.
- Keep your focus on the strategic objective, you can keep questions targeted and concise and within the institution's mandate.

Strategies for Lobbying at local, national and international levels

Position papers

A position paper is a statement that makes clear exactly what your organization's (or coalition of organizations') view on a particular issue is for everyone (external audience). It is an unambiguous statement that is continually referred to when dealing with both allies and opponents, particularly when targeting advocacy at policy-makers. The message is: 'This is what we think about this issue, and this is what we recommend'.

Position papers should all offer the following:

- Statement of main recommendation: One to two sentences.
- Background: Explanation of why the position paper has been written (what situation brought up the issue for advocacy).
- List of laws, international treaties, decrees, policies, etc, which support the recommendation.
- Evidence supporting the recommendation: Situating the issue amongst other such issues.
- Quantitative evidence: Facts and figures.
- Qualitative evidence: Case studies, personal testimonies, anecdotes or examples supporting the recommendation.

- Our position: Logical explanation of how the evidence leads to the recommendations.
  Answers to possible questions or objections.
- Recommendations: Specific, realistic actions that the decision-maker can take.
  Organizations and individuals supporting this position paper.
- The name of your organization or coalition, and logo if appropriate.

BRIEFING NOTES

This document should be seen by individuals within the organization or within the advocacy alliance only – to assist them in delivering advocacy messages. The briefing notes should contain possible strategies, tactics, minimum demands that cannot be compromised Include possible questions that might be asked, and suggested answers Include problematic issues that might arise, and suggest how to deal with them. It is basically a less formal position paper. Tips for position papers and briefing notes:

- Use appropriate language for your target audiences.
- Tailor your position paper/briefing note to a particular audience for a particular reason.
- Give full references of any research or information quoted.
- Make sure the appropriate people have been consulted.
- Ensure that everyone in the organization understands the position the organization is taking.
- Do not quote people without their permission or break confidentiality with subjects from case studies.
- Do not use abbreviations unless necessary.

In person lobbying

To lobby is to seek to influence advocacy stakeholders especially politicians or public officials on your advocacy issue.

Tips

- Recognize and acknowledge any previous work or statements of the target
- Acknowledge points of mutuality
- Find a balance in the discussion – you both need to hear each other – your opinions, his or her response. If going as a delegation, choose who speaks at what point
- Keep your messages clear and limit their number
- Establish your credentials to speak about your issue, while acknowledging the target's area of expertise or specialization
- Being open to negotiation around the issue is advantageous – i.e. being seen to be 'reasonable'
- Keep your demands to a minimum
- Avoid technical jargon – use simple language that is understandable by the general public
- Establish what your target might be willing to do
- Be mindful that you probably have much more specific information on the application of the right you are addressing than your target.

CONCLUSIONS

In Nigeria, intersex people often face systemic discrimination, stigma, and human rights violations. The existing cultural and societal norms perpetuate harmful practices and attitudes towards intersex individuals, leaving them vulnerable to violence and the denial of basic human rights.

There are medical interventions without consent, forced surgeries, and a lack of access to appropriate healthcare. These practices not only violate their bodily autonomy but also create flawed perceptions of who they are and encourage harmful myths and misconceptions about intersex identities. Thus leading to the absence of legal protections.

This manual serves as a detailed resource pool for individuals and organisations seeking to advocate for the rights of intersex persons in Nigeria. By highlighting the fundamental concepts of intersexuality, the creation process of this manual, and its structured framework, it has provided a guide for efficient and vast advocacy.

It emphasises the importance of understanding advocacy approaches, power dynamics, and the legal and social realities faced by intersex individuals in Nigeria. Exploring the intersections of advocacy, power, and stakeholder engagement equips advocates with the knowledge, materials, and tools necessary to steer complex advocacy issues and effect meaningful change.

Additionally, the significance of intersectionality is also important in advocacy efforts. When we advocate for intersex rights through an intersectional lens, we can properly recognize the diverse experiences within the intersex community. It ensures that everyone is seen, valued, and heard.

In its entirety, this manual serves as a call to action for advocates, rightsholders, policymakers, and stakeholders to join together in the fight for intersex rights in Nigeria. By utilizing the contents outlined in this manual, we allow for a start to working towards a more inclusive and equitable society where intersex persons can live free from discrimination and oppression in all aspects of their lives.

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This document was developed and published
by Intersex Nigeria

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